THE DAY ONE PLAYBOOK

An unofficial launch guide for Grand Theft Auto VI players

Edition 1.0 — Pre-launch · Facts checked 9 November 2026

Buy once, get every update. Edition 1.1 (the first-week field notes) ships after launch.

> **Unofficial.** This guide is not made, endorsed or sponsored by Rockstar Games or Take-Two Interactive. *Grand Theft Auto* and *GTA* are trademarks of Take-Two Interactive. The names are used only to say which game this guide is about. No game art, logos, leaked material or datamined files are in this guide.

HOW TO USE THIS GUIDE

Most "GTA 6 guides" for sale right now were written before anyone played the game. They pad the page count with rumours presented as facts. This guide does the opposite. Each claim is labelled:

Label	Meaning
CONFIRMED	Stated by Rockstar, Take-Two, Sony or Microsoft.
REPORTED	Several credible outlets report it, but there is no first-party statement.
RUMOUR	Speculation. Listed only so you can ignore it on purpose.

If Rockstar changes something, this guide gets updated and you get the new edition free.

PART 1 — THE FACT SHEET

What	Detail	Status
Release date	**Thursday 19 November 2026**	CONFIRMED
Platforms at launch	PlayStation 5, Xbox Series X and Xbox Series S	CONFIRMED
PC	No date announced. A 2027 window is rumoured.	RUMOUR
Standard Edition (US)	**$79.99**	CONFIRMED
Ultimate Edition (US)	**$99.99**	CONFIRMED
Upgrade from Standard to Ultimate	No price confirmed. One store listing shows $20.	REPORTED
Digital pre-load opens	**10 November 2026.** Xbox opens at 12:00 a.m. GMT worldwide. PS5 opens at midnight in your own time zone.	CONFIRMED (Rockstar Pre-Load FAQ)
Install space needed	**Up to 212 GB**, depending on your device	CONFIRMED
Physical copies	At retailers from 12 November. Some are code-in-box (a download code, not a full disc).	REPORTED
Pre-order bonus (Standard)	Vintage Vice City Pack plus one month of GTA+	REPORTED: check your store page
Online multiplayer at launch	**None.** The game launches as single-player only.	CONFIRMED (launch scope); timing of any online mode is unannounced
Existing GTA Online (GTA V)	Not being shut down	REPORTED
Setting	The state of Leonida, based on Florida. Vice City plus regions including Ambrosia, Grassrivers, the Leonida Keys, Mount Kalaga National Park and Port Gellhorn.	CONFIRMED (official trailer and site material)
Lead characters	Jason Duval and Lucia Caminos	CONFIRMED
Delay history	Delayed twice: first to 26 May 2026, then to 19 November 2026	CONFIRMED

Rumours to ignore on purpose

- **"Online launches the same day."** Rockstar has said nothing to support this.
- **"PC comes out in Q1 2027."** Nobody official has given a PC date.

- **Exact map size, vehicle counts, mission counts.** Any precise number you see before 19 November is a guess.

PART 2 — THE STORAGE PLAN (DO THIS TONIGHT)

The game needs up to 212 GB **free**, and patches arrive on top of that. Plan for **250 GB free** so a launch patch doesn't block you.

Find out where you stand

Console	Usable storage out of the box (approx.)	What to do
PS5 (825 GB model)	~667 GB	Usually fine. Check the free space you actually have.
PS5 Slim / Pro (1 TB / 2 TB)	~848 GB / ~1.8 TB	Usually fine.
Xbox Series X (1 TB)	~802 GB	Usually fine.
Xbox Series S (512 GB)	**~362 GB**	**High risk.** The game takes more than half the drive. Clear space first.

Usable-space figures are approximate system numbers and vary with firmware.

The 10-minute clear-out

1. **Sort installed games by size** in your console's storage menu.
2. **Uninstall anything you haven't played in 60 days.** Your saves stay in the cloud. Check this first if you don't have PS Plus or Xbox cloud saves turned on.
3. **Delete old video captures.** Captures can take up tens of gigabytes without you noticing.
4. **Move games to external storage.** On both consoles, a USB drive can *store* current-gen games, but they **must run from internal storage or an approved expansion**. Use the USB drive as a parking spot, not a place to play from.
5. **Check again:** you're aiming for 250 GB free.

Pre-load checklist

- ☐ The pre-order is on the **same account** you'll play on
- ☐ Auto-updates are on, so the day-one patch installs overnight
- ☐ The console is in rest mode (PS5) or "Sleep" power mode (Xbox), so it can download while it's off
- ☐ Check on the morning of the 18th that the download says **100%**, not "waiting"

PART 3 — WHICH EDITION, HONESTLY

You are…	Buy
Here for the story, will play it once	**Standard ($79.99)**
Unsure	**Standard.** Rockstar's upgrade path means you aren't locked in.
Sure you'll put in 100+ hours and want every launch bonus	Ultimate ($99.99). Read the bonus list on your store page and judge it on what's there, not on hype.

The disconfirming point: the Ultimate bonuses are extra content and cosmetics. The main story is the same in both editions. Online isn't available at launch, so "head start in Online" type bonuses don't help you on day one.

Physical vs digital: a code-in-box copy still downloads the full 212 GB. Buy it for the box or the resale value, not to save bandwidth.

PART 4 — LAUNCH WEEK, DAY BY DAY

Date	Do this
Mon 9 Nov	Clear storage (Part 2). Check that your pre-order is there.
Tue 10 Nov	Pre-load opens. Start it the same day. 212 GB on a 100 Mbps connection takes roughly 4.5–5 hours in ideal conditions, and launch-week servers are rarely ideal.
Thu 12 Nov	Physical copies reported to arrive. If you bought one, install from the code now.
12–18 Nov	**Spoiler lockdown** (Part 6).
Wed 18 Nov	Confirm the pre-load is at 100%. Charge your controllers. Download the day-one patch if it's out.
Thu 19 Nov	Launch. Play the story. Online isn't something you can rush yet.
Fri 20 Nov	Reported last day for pre-order bonuses if you haven't bought yet.

PART 5 — YOUR FIRST SESSION: HABITS THAT PAY OFF IN ANY ROCKSTAR OPEN WORLD

None of this depends on unreleased mechanics. These are habits that have worked across Rockstar's open-world games, and they'll be checked against the real game in Edition 1.1.

1. **Go through every settings menu before the first mission.** Subtitles, camera sensitivity, aim assist, HUD size and audio mix. Changing them 10 hours in feels worse than spending 10 minutes now.
2. **Turn on any performance or quality mode you prefer** (if the game offers one) before you form an opinion of how it looks.
3. **Save by hand before anything big.** Don't rely only on autosaves.
4. **Do the story first and explore after.** Rockstar often unlocks activities and map areas through story progress. Exploring too early can mean finding locked doors.
5. **Don't spend all your in-game money early.** Rockstar economies usually reward patience, such as property or business purchases unlocked later. *(We'll check whether this holds in VI.)*
6. **Write down where things are.** A plain notes app beats trying to remember a shop, a hidden spot or a side-activity location three days later.
7. **Take a break every 2 hours.** Launch-week burnout is real.

PART 6 — SPOILER LOCKDOWN

Leaks and early copies tend to hit social media before launch.

- **YouTube:** pause watch history, and click "Not interested" on any GTA VI upload titled "ending", "full story" or "all missions".
- **X / Threads / Bluesky:** mute these words: `GTA 6 ending`, `GTA VI ending`, `Lucia dies`, `Jason dies`, `final mission`, `leaked gameplay`.
- **Reddit:** stay out of general gaming subreddits until you've finished the story.
- **TikTok:** long-press and choose "Not interested" on the first spoiler you see. The algorithm learns quickly.

The muted-word list above is a filter list, not a hint about the plot. Nobody outside Rockstar knows the ending yet.

PART 7 — FOR CREATORS: RECORD YOUR LAUNCH PROPERLY

If you plan to post clips, set this up **before** launch night.

- **Read Rockstar's video policy** (Rockstar Support: *"Policy on posting copyrighted Rockstar Games material"*). Gameplay footage is generally allowed. **Using Rockstar logos or official art to suggest you're endorsed is not.**

- **Licensed in-game radio music can trigger Content ID claims.** Turn the radio down or off for clips you plan to post.
- **PS5:** set the capture length and resolution in *Settings › Captures and Broadcasts*.
- **Xbox:** set the clip length and resolution in *Settings › Preferences › Capture & share*.
- **Mark ending and late-story uploads as spoilers** in the title and thumbnail. Audiences remember who spoiled them.

PART 8 — WHAT EDITION 1.1 ADDS (FREE TO YOU)

Within the first week after 19 November, this guide gets field notes from real play:

- ☐ Verified settings recommendations
- ☐ An early-game money plan, based on how the economy actually works
- ☐ Side activities worth doing first, and ones to skip
- ☐ Corrections to anything in Part 5 the real game proves wrong
- ☐ An Online section once Rockstar announces it

You'll get the update in your purchase library and by email.

SOURCES (CHECKED 9 NOVEMBER 2026)

- Rockstar Support: *Grand Theft Auto VI Pre-Load FAQ*
- Rockstar Support: *Policy on posting copyrighted Rockstar Games material*
- Rockstar mod guidelines (September 2026), as reported by Insider Gaming, MP1st and Dot Esports
- Pre-load date, time and 212 GB size, as reported by VGC, Guru3D, HotHardware and Notebookcheck
- Series S storage analysis, as reported by IBTimes UK
- Single-player-only launch scope, as reported by OpenCritic and dlcompare
- Trailer 2 setting and characters, as reported by GamesRadar, TechRadar and Shacknews

Prices are US list prices and vary by region and retailer. Check your own store before you buy.